

Returning With a New Rhythm

You may answer privately, in prayer, without writing everything down. Nothing here is graded or collected. If a card concerns immediate safety, medical care, suicidal thoughts, abuse, safeguarding, or a genuine crisis, do not place it in the 30-day plan: seek the appropriate help promptly.

1 · Opening the envelope

Mark each card from the Session 1 envelope: **A** something within your responsibility that needs a next faithful action · **S** something to share · **E** something to entrust · **?** something needing counsel. Anything that no longer needs to be done, set aside.

Card	Mark

2 · Self-assessment

1. Reread the three questions you answered in Lesson 1, and your answers. Then reread your intention from Lesson 7, all four parts. Without forcing it: what has shifted, what has become clearer, and what may still need attention, support, prayer, or discernment after you return? Write honestly, including “nothing yet” if that is true. This is not a test of whether the retreat worked.

2. Lay out the practical and discernment cards together. What do you notice? Is there a theme, a person who appears more than once, a concern that keeps returning? A repeated theme is worth noticing, but repetition alone does not prove that it is God’s central message. It may indicate anxiety, an intrusive concern, an unmet need, or a genuine priority requiring further discernment.

3. Was there a moment, exercise, rest period, conversation, or passage that seems especially important? If nothing stands out yet, write that.

4. What are you afraid will happen when you get home?

4 • Silence

Ten minutes, or the length you can manage. The last silence of the retreat. “Go, return on your way.”
Or: “I am not alone.”

5 • Journal

1. What did you notice in the last silence?

2. Of everything that happened, what one thing do you most want to be true in a month's time? Write it as a sentence beginning “In a month, I hope...”

3. Who will you tell about the retreat, and what will you tell them? Who will you not tell yet, and why?

4. What is the next deliberate pause or form of support you need? It might be a three-hour reset, a day retreat, a counselling appointment, a Sabbath practice, or a protected hour. Write it down. A rhythm needs a next time.

6 • Four things to take home

One card each. Small, specific, and within your present capacity. Read the four cards to God.

Cards to cut out

One thing to entrust

... placed in God's care.

One action to take (in the first two weeks home)

One person or source of support (and when I will contact them)

One sustainable rhythm, for thirty days

Day: _____ Time: _____ Place: _____

When I miss it, I will start again the next day without guilt.

Then sort every card from the retreat. **Action cards** (the four, plus safe practical reminders) go somewhere accessible; the 30-day plan begins with them on Day 1. **Private cards** (anything sensitive, identifying, traumatic, or spiritually intimate, including the sealed envelopes) are sealed or securely stored. If your belongings may be searched or monitored, do not carry written material that could place you at risk.

Optional sessions to revisit (only if you deferred any)

7 • Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

I came as honestly as I could, and grace met me here.

I am returning with some clarity and some unfinished questions.

I will not carry ordinary life alone.

I take one small rhythm and one next faithful step.

My retreat experience is not the measure of God's faithfulness.

(Optional:) My name is written in heaven, and that is what I will rejoice in.

8 • A blessing

Aloud, if you can.

The LORD bless you and keep you;

the LORD make his face to shine upon you and be gracious to you;

the LORD lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace.

Numbers 6:24–26 • ESV